

Bilibili Inc. (BILI): Asia Leaders Conference 2026 Takeaways: Multiple advertising growth levers; Enhanced game pipeline and disciplined AI

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We hosted Bili CFO and IR team on Sep 2 at our GS Asia Leaders Conference 2026 in Hong Kong.

Bottom line: Management discussion and investor focus are centered around 1) solid advertising growth through higher traffic, ad load, eCPM, new formats and verticals/scenarios expansion, 2) 2026-27 game pipeline, 3) measured AI investment and efficiency gains, 4) sufficient cash for shareholder returns.

We summarize our key takeaways within.

Key takeaways

Advertising

- **Performance ads** contribute **50%+** of total advertising revenue, and management sees solid momentum driven by 1) healthy user traffic and time spent growth, 2) **ad load** could rise gradually from c. **7%** currently to **10%+ longer term**, versus low-teens% of peers, 3) **eCPM** was broadly flat yoy in 1H26 amid weak macro, but management sees a **normalized high-single-digit% yoy** annual growth potential as conversion continues to improve. Management elaborated that c. 10% yoy growth for eCPM in 4Q25 reflected fewer impressions delivering the same revenue rather than higher advertiser bids. Advertiser bids remained broadly stable yoy yet with higher ROI requirements while the number of advertisers grew **double-digit% yoy** in 1H26.
- **Brand ads** remain **macro-sensitive**, although the weak 2H26 should provide an easier base for next year. Management noted Bili's average user age has risen by 0.6-0.7 years annually to **26.5**, and they are increasingly attractive target audience for advertisers.
- **Growth by vertical: Home furnishing, renovation and appliances** doubled yoy in 1H26, **Internet services** (including AI-related sectors) and **Autos** (up

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high-double-digit% yoy in 2Q26) also grew rapidly. Food & Beverage was softer, Beauty & Cosmetics continued to underperform, and consumer categories grew below average with limited growth in 618.

- Management will focus on **expanding to new verticals and ad scenarios**. For instance, Beauty & Cosmetics remains a sizable opportunity, supported by the growing female users from increasing music, film and variety show content in Bili. TV ads and PC ads also performed well, making large screens an incremental scenario for Bili's monetization. Moreover, Bili launched **automated ad placement solutions** in end-2025 and is planned to cover all industries by end-2026 to enable SMEs.

Games

- **2H26 pipeline.** 1) Bili's self-developed **Lumi Master** is scheduled for global launch on **Sep 17**, with revenue contribution expected to kick in from 4Q26. Management believes its **normalized margins should be relatively high** given low maintenance costs. 2) **Sangokushi: Wangdao Tianxia** is slated for **4Q26**, with expected ARPU and paying ratio above *Sanguo: NSLG* but below *Three Kingdoms: Strategy Edition*. The strategic objective is to stabilize Bili's Sanguo/SLG franchise and gain market share.
- **2027 pipeline.** 1) **RO3**, an official sequel rather than an IP-licensed adaptation; 2) **Guild Wars: Big Hero** (激战: 大牌英雄), a title whose gameplay is similar to *Hearthstone*; 3) Self-developed tactical RPG game **Sanguo: The Ravages of Time**.

AI investment and efficiency improvement

- **Rmb1bn** of Capex for 2026 is mainly allocated to hardware, servers and chips, with computing power primarily leased. Management said 70%-80% of the budget was already spent in 1H26, but only c. **Rmb500mn impact is expected for 2026 P&L**. Overall AI investment remains measured, with video understanding as a key focus.
 - Bili's AI tool **Updream exceeded Rmb100mn ARR in its first month** and nearly doubled in the second month, while related computing costs are already reflected in the P&L without generating a meaningful impact.
 - **Efficiency initiatives have started**, although workflow-related savings should take time to become more visible.

Shareholder returns

- Bili has **sufficient offshore funding** for buybacks, with c. 50% of its cash overseas and its domestic operations remaining cash-positive.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Bilibili, Inc.

Valuation methodology: We are **Buy** rated on Bilibili (BILI/9626.HK) with 12-month DCF-based target prices of **US\$27.7/HK\$216** (WACC at 12.7%, terminal growth rate at 3%).

Key downside risks: 1) Ads slowdown on macro and/or slower-than-expected monetization execution; 2) Weaker-than-expected game grossing and sustainability; 3) Losses if content costs/revenue sharing do not fall as a percentage of revenue.

BILI	12m Price Target: \$27.70	Price: \$15.79	Upside: 75.4%
9626.HK	12m Price Target: HK\$216.00	Price: HK\$121.70	Upside: 77.5%

Buy		GS Forecast			
Market cap: \$6.6bn Enterprise value: \$3.8bn 3m ADTV: \$43.7mn China China Games, Entertainment & Healthcare Tech M&A Rank: 3 Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Revenue (Rmb mn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	30,347.8	32,971.0	36,542.5	39,685.2
	EPS (Rmb)	4,665.3	5,107.6	5,991.6	7,375.1
	P/E (X)	5.84	6.82	8.91	10.73
	P/B (X)	27.3	15.6	11.9	9.9
	Dividend yield (%)	4.3	2.5	2.1	1.8
	N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X)	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
	CROCI (%)	(3.3)	(3.7)	(4.1)	(4.2)
	FCF yield (%)	23.1	25.4	32.0	36.4
		5.5	8.1	12.3	13.4
		3/26	6/26	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	1.31	1.58	1.85	2.12

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 1 Sep 2026 close.

Disclosure Appendix

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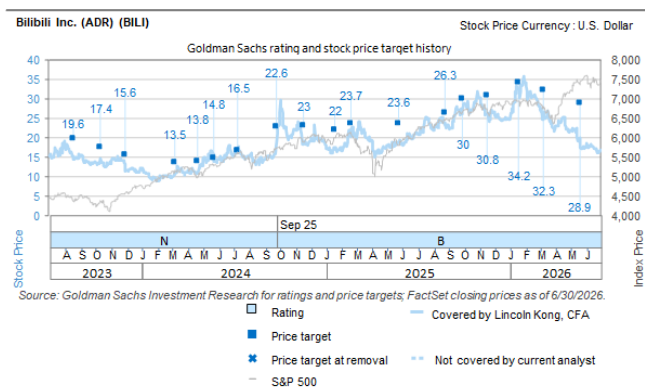
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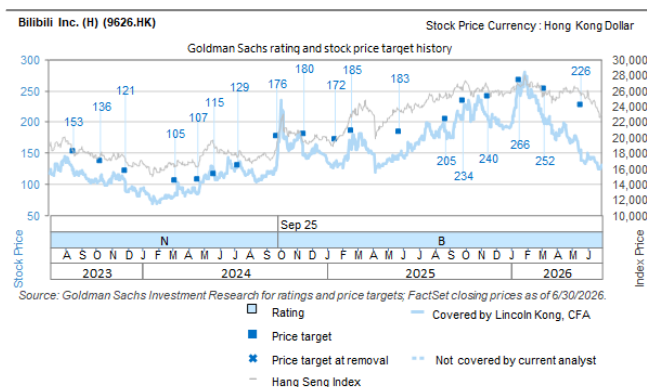
	Rating Distribution				Investment Banking Relationships		
	Buy	Hold	Sell		Buy	Hold	Sell
Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

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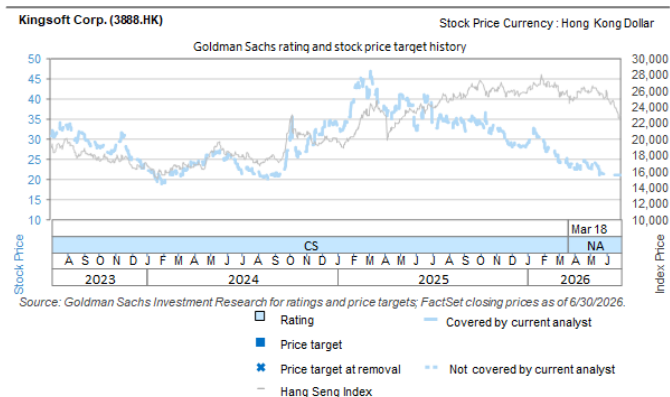
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Target price history table(s)

Bilibili Inc. (H) (9626.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
27-Aug-26	216.00	129.70
19-May-26	226.00	156.10
09-Mar-26	252.00	197.60
18-Jan-26	266.00	260.00
16-Nov-25	240.00	209.00
29-Sep-25	234.00	210.60
25-Aug-25	205.00	186.70
25-May-25	183.00	146.40

Bilibili Inc. (ADR) (BILI)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
27-Aug-26	27.70	16.77
19-May-26	28.90	20.00
09-Mar-26	32.30	26.16
18-Jan-26	34.20	32.48
16-Nov-25	30.80	26.18
29-Sep-25	30.00	27.33
25-Aug-25	26.30	23.25
25-May-25	23.60	18.94

Bilibili Inc. (H) (9626.HK)

Date of report	Target price (HK\$)	Closing price (HK\$)
20-Feb-25	185.00	154.80
19-Jan-25	172.00	134.60
17-Nov-24	180.00	146.10
25-Sep-24	176.00	136.50
10-Jul-24	129.00	130.50
23-May-24	115.00	119.80
21-Apr-24	107.00	85.25
07-Mar-24	105.00	85.65
29-Nov-23	121.00	101.00
11-Oct-23	136.00	111.80

Bilibili Inc. (ADR) (BILI)

Date of report	Target price (\$)	Closing price (\$)
20-Feb-25	23.70	22.11
19-Jan-25	22.00	17.47
17-Nov-24	23.00	18.30
25-Sep-24	22.60	18.27
10-Jul-24	16.50	16.96
23-May-24	14.80	13.74
21-Apr-24	13.80	10.91
07-Mar-24	13.50	10.60
29-Nov-23	15.60	11.86
11-Oct-23	17.40	14.65

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